Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Robin Banks

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Mona Lott** on strategy.
- **Barb Dwyer** has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- **Anne E. Dote** quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Robin Banks. I campaign for restitution. A disputed object does not become less disputed when somebody puts flowers beside it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Robin Banks

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Wants a hearing for people made invisible by possession. Being excluded by security has become a personal grievance.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Robin Banks

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A trophy is more than decoration tonight. Check below its foot.*

2 *Where red drapes close the scene, evidence waits out of sight.*

3 *A secret has been put on ice, quite literally.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I wanted the bowl returned intact or the claimants heard. Grant wanted applause first. I threatened to disrupt the announcement if he refused. Barb understood me. She's removed me from an event before. I remember what people called me as I left. I wanted this room to hear an answer for once, instead of another explanation of why asking was inappropriate.

IF MURDERER

I wanted a hearing for the claimants. Grant wanted applause first. I threatened to disrupt the announcement. He could have security exclude me and call that protecting the museum. Barb has removed me before. I remember the door closing. Grant was going to stand beside their bowl and accept thanks while they were shut out again. I wasn't willing to leave politely.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Robin Banks

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I went looking for Grant with the petition. Paige was asking about the gift; I interrupted. At intake I'd taken the bowl's ownership card and kept it inside my copy. Barb had warned me once already. I stayed after Grant told me to leave. I was not going to stand politely at the back while he thanked himself.

IF MURDERER

> I distributed the petition after security warned me. I gave Grant his copy during Paige's interview at the public podium. Later I took the signature page back to the announcement desk. I wanted him to sign it. I didn't go into his private room. Barb, I wasn't leaving people's names with him without an answer. You know how long we've been asking.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I handed him the petition in his private room while Paige recorded. He told me it wasn't a public podium. I knew that. The card I took belongs to the bowl. Barb, I stayed after you told me to leave. I wanted an answer. His death isn't one.

IF MURDERER

> I took a sample of the contents at the preview. I wanted proof of what this museum was calling harmless. I did not take it into Grant's private room. The interview was at the public podium; that is the exchange on Paige's recorder. I brought the signature page to the announcement desk. Ask Paige where we stood.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Robin Banks

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Robin Banks

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The interview opening places my petition at his private table. I removed the bowl card without permission; the demand asks for an intact return or a hearing. It is still unanswered. Anne, if you agree with it, say so where leadership can hear. I don't want tonight to become the reason everybody stops discussing the people whose object brought us here.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I delivered the petition at his private place. The recording is right; my public gallery account was not. I had taken poison during the preview. Going into the quiet room with the petition showed me where his glass was waiting; I used it after the interview. The demand called for a hearing and an intact return. It authorized none of what I did. The claimants asked for their bowl and a hearing. I have made them defend themselves against my act. I had no right to do that in their name.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.